

Access Policy — ZW-BioBank v1.0

Sovereign controlled access · tiers, roles, security, retention

Position

ZW-BioBank is a Zimbabwean national research asset. It is not an open commons, and the decision not to make it one is deliberate. An open licence severs provenance at the first redistribution: once a record is copied without its consent conditions attached, the chain from a compound back to a knowledge holder is broken and no benefit-sharing claim can be proved. That severance is the mechanism by which extractive bioprospecting works. Controlled access is how this dataset refuses to participate in it.

Tiers

Tier	Contents	Conditions	Approver
Public	Schema, data dictionary, metadata cards, validation code, aggregate statistics, ward-level locations	Open. Attribution requested.	None
Research	Records classified public; raw sequence and spectra	Data Access Agreement. Institutional affiliation. No re-identification attempt. No onward transfer. Publications must credit the originating community.	SIRDC
Restricted	Records classified community-restricted; field-precision coordinates; consented audio	Case by case. Purpose must be stated and bounded.	SIRDC and the relevant community council. Both required; neither sufficient alone.
Commercial	As negotiated	Executed benefit-sharing agreement with the originating community, in force before access. No exceptions and no retrospective agreements.	SIRDC and community council
Sacred knowledge	Not collected	There is no tier under which it could be released, because there is no field in which it could be stored.	Not applicable

Roles

SIRDC (primary steward)	Legal custody, governance authority, access approval, key custody for encrypted material, long-term permanence.
Miti AI (technical maintainer)	Pipeline, curation, validation, versioning and access portal. No unilateral release authority.
Community councils	Endorse collection; hold concurrence rights over restricted and commercial access to their communities' records.
Knowledge holders	Classify their own knowledge; withdraw at any time; named co-contribution where opted in.
Data recipients	Bound by the terms of their tier, including onward-licensing restrictions and withdrawal obligations.

Security

AES-256 at rest and in transit for all restricted material. Role-based access with logged access events. Restricted material is not present in any distributed package, so separation is physical rather than

permission-based. Backups are encrypted and held within Zimbabwe. Suspected breach of restricted heritage material triggers notification to SIRDC and to the affected community council within 72 hours, and suspension of the relevant tier pending review.

Retention and deletion

Public environmental and genomic records	Retained indefinitely as a national asset.
Metabolomic profiles	Retained indefinitely; commercial access remains gated.
Restricted heritage records	Reviewed with the originating community every two years. A community may reclassify or withdraw at review.
Consented audio	Retained only while the consent scope covering it remains in force.
Withdrawn records	Pseudonymised or deleted within 30 days of the withdrawal date. Enforced by the validator, which holds the batch until complete.
Quality control log	Retained permanently. The audit trail outlives the records it describes; that is the point of it.

Prohibited uses

At every tier, without exception: surveillance, individual identification, credit assessment, law enforcement, and profiling. These boundaries were declared before collection and are encoded in the governance architecture rather than added to it. The schema contains no field capable of identifying a natural person, which is the most durable form this commitment can take.